6.9 Appendicitis and Appendectomy

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The pain started around my navel and moved to the right side." • Gives the pain 8/10 **Objective** • Tender in the right lower quadrant • Temperature 38.2 °C • WBC up	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to inflammation of the appendix as evidenced by right lower quadrant pain and tenderness.	Pain 3/10 or less before and after surgery.	• Nothing by mouth; give IV fluids as ordered. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Let him lie with his knees slightly bent. • No heat on the abdomen and no laxatives. • If the pain suddenly eases and then spreads all over, report it (could be perforation).	Pain controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Will it be a big operation?" **Objective** • Looks anxious • Keeps asking questions	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to emergency surgery as evidenced by worry and repeated questions.	Says he understands the operation and feels less anxious.	• Explain the procedure and what recovery will be like. • Do the pre-op preparation calmly. • Let the family stay.	Calmer: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Appendix inflamed or perforated • Surgical incision	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: possible perforation and surgical incision.	No wound infection and no abscess.	• Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Watch the temperature, the wound and his abdominal pain. • Get him moving early.	No infection: **goal met**.